

KID CITY · CITY CHURCH LUFKIN



CHILD SAFETY & PROTECTION PROTOCOL

Policies, procedures, and expectations for every Kid City volunteer

LOVE GOD · LOVE OTHERS · BE YOU · HAVE FUN





01

PURPOSE & COMMITMENT

Why child safety is our non-negotiable.

OUR COMMITMENT

Kid City exists to be a safe, nurturing, and spiritually rich environment for every child from birth through 5th grade. Child safety is not a compliance checkbox — it is a ministry value. Every policy in this document exists because every child who walks through our doors is deeply loved by God, and we are entrusted with their protection.

This protocol applies to every person serving in any Kid City environment — paid staff, adult volunteers, and student volunteers alike. There are no exceptions and no gray areas. When in doubt, always err on the side of child safety.

THE WIN

Every parent drops off their child with full confidence. Every child is safe, seen, and protected — every Sunday.

02

VOLUNTEER SCREENING

Who is allowed to serve with children.

REQUIREMENTS BEFORE SERVING

No one may work with children in any Kid City environment until all of the following are completed:

- 01 Three Month Rule**
You must have attended City Church for a minimum of three (3) months before serving with children.
- 02 Volunteer Application**
A completed, signed application on file at the City Church offices. All information is kept strictly confidential.
- 03 Background Check**
A full background check is required for every volunteer — no exceptions. Results are maintained in confidence.
- 04 Personal Interview**
A face-to-face interview with the Kid City Director to discuss your serving role, giftings, and capacity.



05 Reference Checks

Provided references will be verified before approval is granted.

06 Role Training

Complete all training specific to your role before your first Sunday.

07 Volunteer Badge

Obtain and wear your volunteer badge every Sunday. Report to Volunteer Check-In before serving.

STUDENT VOLUNTEERS (Ages 14–17)

Middle school and high school students aged 14 and older may serve in Kid City under the direct supervision of an adult volunteer or staff member. Parent permission is required. Student volunteers are never left alone with any child and may not change diapers or administer food or bottles.

- Check in with the Lead Volunteer at least 30 minutes before service.
- Follow the direction of adult volunteers and staff at all times.
- Never be alone with a child at any time — maintain the Two Adult Rule.
- No personal electronic devices during service hours.
- Must attend the adult or student service during any non-serving time.
- Parent must have signed a clear agreement for the student to volunteer.
- Students are never permitted to change diapers or administer food/bottles.

03 THE TWO ADULT RULE

Our most foundational safety requirement.

■ NON-NEGOTIABLE

A minimum of TWO unrelated adults must be present with children at ALL times — in every room, every hallway interaction, every bathroom escort. This rule is never suspended, not even for a moment.

HOW TO APPLY THE TWO ADULT RULE

In the Classroom

Two adults must be in the room before any child enters. If a second adult steps out, they must return before the first adult steps away.

Bathroom Escorts

A same-gender adult walks the child to the bathroom. The bathroom must be checked clear of other adults first. Door remains cracked. The Two Adult Rule applies — a second adult must be present or visible nearby.



Hallways & Transitions

No adult should be alone with a child in a hallway or transition area. If you see this situation, step in and accompany them.

Emergency Situations

Even in a crisis, work to maintain two adults with children. If unavoidable, keep the door fully open with three or more children present, and notify your team lead immediately.

04

CHECK-IN & CHECK-OUT

Secure entry and release procedures.

CHECK-IN PROCEDURES

01

Open Planning Center Check-Ins on the iPad. Connect to WiFi (C1tyChurchH). Confirm the correct event is selected.

02

Returning families: parent types phone number, selects children, badges print automatically from the assigned Brother printer.

03

First-time families: direct to the First-Time Visitor Podium or QR code. Complete registration, then check in.

04

Each child receives a name badge. Mini City children receive two badges (child + bag). A Parent Pick-Up security tag prints for the parent — they MUST have this for pickup.

05

Allergy flag: YELLOW sticker on badge. Security concern: RED sticker on child's badge and parent tag — notify Safety Team immediately.

06

Check-In closes approximately 20 minutes after service begins. After this point, only adults with a valid Parent Pick-Up tag may enter the Kids wing.

CHECK-OUT & CHILD RELEASE

- Children are NEVER released to anyone who cannot present the correct matching security tag.
- Siblings are NOT permitted to pick up younger brothers or sisters, even if they have the security tag.
- Verify that the number on the parent's sticker matches the child's sticker on every release.
- If a parent cannot present their security tag, contact the Team Leader immediately. Do not release the child.
- If a parent has lost their tag: the child waits until all other children have been picked up, then the parent must show valid government-issued photo ID to the Lead Volunteer.

THE WIN



Every child is released only to the verified guardian. No child leaves the wing without a matched security tag.

05

REPORTING SUSPECTED ABUSE

Mandated reporting obligations and procedure.

■ MANDATED REPORTER OBLIGATION

Kid City staff are Mandated Reporters. Any suspicion of child abuse or neglect **MUST** be reported — immediately and without delay. Do not investigate. Do not confront the alleged abuser. Do not wait to see if the concern resolves.

SIGNS TO WATCH FOR

- Unexplained bruises, burns, cuts, or other physical marks — especially in unusual locations or at various stages of healing.
- A child who seems afraid of a specific adult, or fearful of going home.
- Disclosure by a child of abuse — take every statement seriously, no matter how brief.
- Behavioral changes such as sudden withdrawal, aggression, age-inappropriate sexual knowledge, or regression.
- Visible signs of neglect: consistently dirty clothing, hunger, fatigue, or lack of appropriate care.

REPORTING PROCEDURE

Step 1: Report your concern immediately and privately to the Lead Volunteer or Kid City Staff member. Do not act alone.

Step 2: The team lead or staff person notifies the Kid City Director. Do not disclose to other volunteers or parents.

Step 3: The Kid City Director or designated staff person files the report with civil authorities (Texas DFPS: 1-800-252-5400). This is done same-day.

Step 4: Document what you observed — use specific, factual language. Do not add interpretation or opinion. Keep documentation confidential.

Step 5: Do not inform the alleged abuser or suspected family member that a report has been made.

■ TEXAS DFPS CHILD ABUSE HOTLINE

1-800-252-5400 · txabusehotline.org · Available 24 hours a day, 7 days a week



06

CHILD INTERACTION GUIDELINES

How we engage and correct with love.

APPROPRIATE TOUCH

APPROPRIATE	NOT APPROPRIATE
High fives	Demanding or pressuring hugs
Pat on the back or shoulder	Kissing a child
Side hug (child-initiated)	Lap sitting (for children over toddler age)
Holding hands during activities	Tickling or wrestling
Kneeling to eye level	Any touch a child indicates is unwanted

DISCIPLINE GUIDELINES

Kid City volunteers guide behavior through positive redirection and clear, calm communication. We do not punish — we teach.

- Use a firm but gentle voice when addressing behavior. Maintain calm tone even when redirecting.
- Address the behavior — never the child's character. Say 'that behavior is not okay here' not 'you are being bad.'
- Never use sarcasm, shaming, or language that frightens, mocks, or demeans a child.
- Never make negative remarks about a child's appearance, race, gender, ability, or family.
- Corporal punishment of any kind — including spanking — is strictly prohibited.
- If a child's behavior is persistently disruptive or unsafe, notify your team lead. The team lead will page the parents.

CHILDREN WITH SPECIAL NEEDS

Every child belongs in Kid City — including children with special needs. We do not separate or exclude. Every child participates in all activities. A child requiring additional support will be paired with a dedicated volunteer who works one-on-one within the classroom environment. Speak with the Kid City Director in advance to ensure appropriate support is in place.



07

EMERGENCY PROCEDURES

What to do when something goes wrong.

EVACUATION PROCEDURE

- The Lead Volunteer is the designated point person in any evacuation.
- Gather all children into a group immediately. Do not leave any child behind.
- Infants: transport in cribs or strollers. Toddlers: walk or carry.
- Follow posted exit signs to the nearest exterior door.
- Once outside, take attendance and account for every child by name.
- Do not re-enter the building until cleared by Safety Team or emergency personnel.
- Notify Kid City Director as soon as all children are safe and accounted for.

LIFE-THREATENING EMERGENCIES

■ CALL 911 FIRST

For any life-threatening situation — loss of consciousness, significant blood loss, difficulty breathing, or cardiac event — call 911 immediately. Then notify your team leader. Do not wait for staff direction before calling 911.

MINOR ACCIDENTS

For non-life-threatening injuries (minor cuts, scrapes, bumps): treat using the first-aid kit located in each room. Complete an Incident Report form before the end of service. The witness of the accident must complete the report — not the team lead. Notify the parent at pick-up and be honest — do not minimize what occurred.

PAGING A PARENT DURING SERVICE

Page a parent for any of the following:

- A child has been crying consistently for 10 or more minutes.
- A child is ill or showing symptoms of illness.
- A child is persistently disruptive and is not responding to redirection.
- A child has been injured.

How to page: Notify the Volunteer Leader with the child's name and security sticker number. The Leader contacts the Production Director via Planning Center Live — a message appears on the screen in the adult service. The parent comes to Check-In and is escorted to the classroom.



08

COMMUNICATION & CONDUCT

Online, social, and volunteer standards.

SOCIAL MEDIA & PHOTOGRAPHY

- Do not photograph or video record children in Kid City for personal social media use.
- Do not post images of children without explicit parental consent.
- Official photography for ministry use is handled by City Church staff or approved media team members only.
- Do not communicate privately with children through personal social media accounts.

ONE-ON-ONE COMMUNICATION WITH MINORS

All communications between volunteers and minors should be transparent and ministry-related. Do not engage in private one-on-one digital communication with a child. If you must contact a family, communicate with the parent — not the child directly.

PERSONAL CONDUCT

- Arrive 30 minutes before service. Your room needs you before families arrive.
- Wear your volunteer badge visibly at all times during service.
- No personal electronic devices in use during Kid City service hours.
- If you cannot serve on a scheduled day, communicate as early as possible through Planning Center or GroupMe.
- Alert your team lead immediately of any safety concern, allergy issue, or suspicious situation.

THE WIN

We hold these standards because we take the trust of every family seriously. Protecting children is not a burden — it is the highest form of love we can show them.

Questions or concerns?

Contact the Kid City Director at City Church Lufkin.
citychurchlufkin.com · Updated June 2026